

St. Joseph's Anglo-Chinese School

F.5 English Language

Grammar - Lesson 2: Inversions

Inversions

Part 1: Proofreading quiz

Each sentence contains ONE error. Underline the error and write the full corrected sentence. Items 1–5 review relative clauses from Lesson 1; Item 6 previews today's topic — inversions.

Sentence	Correction
Social media connects people instantly which makes the world feel smaller.	
Online courses are ideal for busy adults, especially those which have little time to attend classes.	
There are dozens of messaging apps, all of them are free to use.	
The forum which students share their homework is very popular.	
Many teenagers spend hours gaming, that worries their parents.	
Not only the internet connects people around the world, but it also spreads information quickly.	

Part 2: Three patterns for formal writing

The three patterns in this part all follow the same rule: the auxiliary verb (or the verb 'be') moves before the subject. Each pattern can lift a formal paragraph towards a higher band.

Pattern 1: Not only ... but also ...

Structure:	Not only + auxiliary + subject + verb, but (subject) also + verb
Use in formal writing:	Adds a second advantage in proposals, reports and articles.
Example:	Not only does the scheme save money, but it also builds confidence.

Introducing a school e-learning platform would bring clear benefits. Not only does the platform give students round-the-clock access to learning materials, but it also allows teachers to track progress more closely. With such a system, revision becomes a habit rather than a scramble before exams.

Pattern 2: Never / Rarely / Seldom

Structure:	Never / Rarely / Seldom + auxiliary + subject + verb
Use in formal writing:	Turns a criticism or a surprising claim into a formal, striking opening.
Example:	Rarely do we question our daily screen habits.

Many parents blame video games for every poor result. Rarely do they stop to consider how limited their children's other entertainment options are. The real problem may be the lack of balance, not the games themselves.

Pattern 3: Only by ...

Structure:	Only by + -ing / noun phrase + auxiliary + subject + verb
Use in formal writing:	Sets a condition that leads to a result — ideal for conclusions and recommendations.
Example:	Only by upgrading the campus network can the school offer reliable online lessons.

Working from home has become common in many industries. Only by investing in secure networks and clear communication tools can companies keep their teams productive. Technology can help, but good management matters more.

Part 3: Practice sets

Rewrite each simple sentence using the pattern given in the prompt. The sentences are all about technology and communication, so keep the register formal.

Example Set 1 (Not only ... but also ...)

Simple sentence:	The online platform saves paper, and it gives students instant feedback.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Not only' to add a second advantage.</i>

Example Set 2 (Not only ... but also ...)

Simple sentence:	E-books are cheaper than printed textbooks, and they are far lighter to carry.
Prompt:	<i>Use 'Not only ... but also ...' to combine the two advantages of e-books.</i>

Example Set 3 (Never / Rarely / Seldom)

Simple sentence:	Parents rarely check what their children are doing online.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Rarely'.</i>

Example Set 4 (Never / Rarely / Seldom)

Simple sentence:	The workplace has never relied so heavily on technology.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Never'.</i>

Example Set 5 (Only by ...)

Simple sentence:	Schools can protect students' privacy by issuing clear guidelines on social media use.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Only by'.</i>

Example Set 6 (Only by ...)

Simple sentence:	Bookshops can survive in the digital age by offering experiences that apps cannot match.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Only by'.</i>

Part 4: Writing Task

Instructions:

Social media plays a big part in students' lives. Write ONE paragraph (about 80–100 words) giving your view on whether students should limit their use of social media. Use ONE inversion and ONE relative clause. Remember: the flow of ideas comes first — never force in an inversion for the sake of using one.